

Future of the Web Developer Program: Student Branding Survey

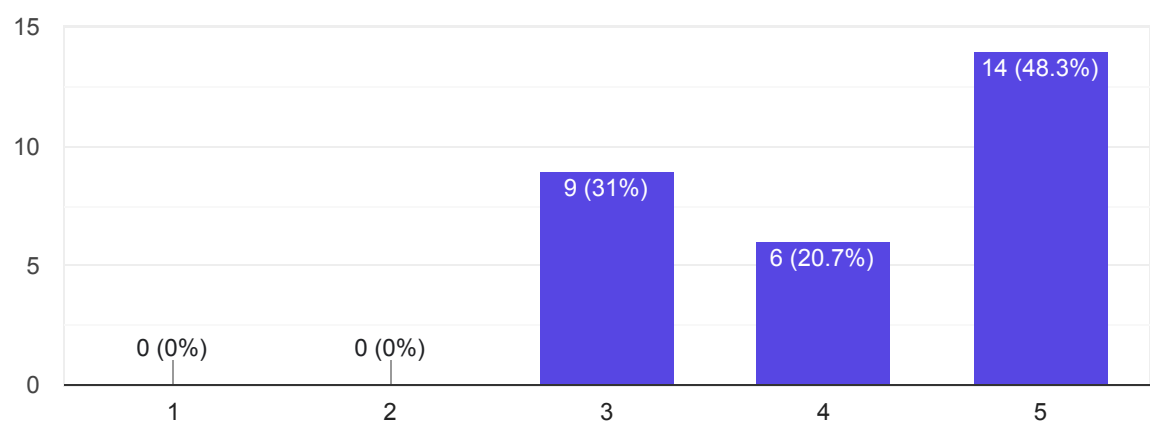
29 responses

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How important do you believe AI proficiency is for a Web Developer entering the 2026 job market?

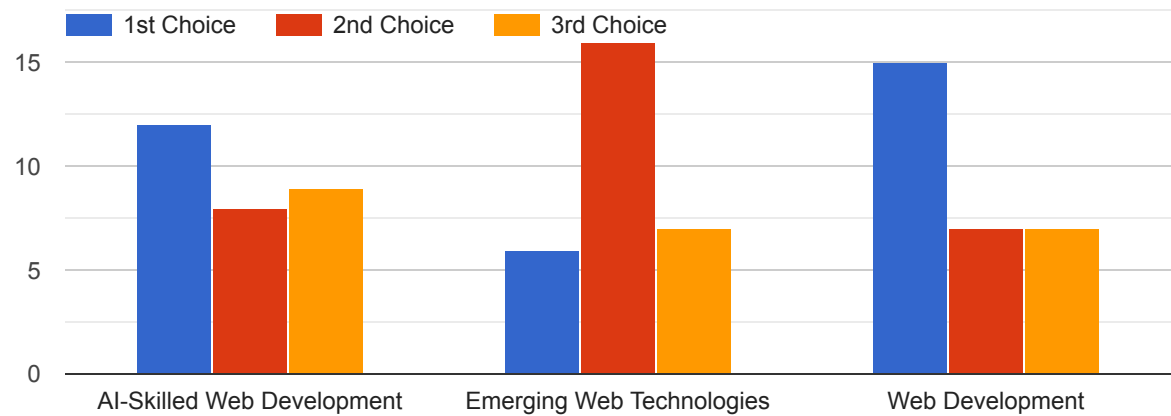
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29 responses



Please rank the following program titles based on which you believe would be most impressive to a hiring manager on your resume.

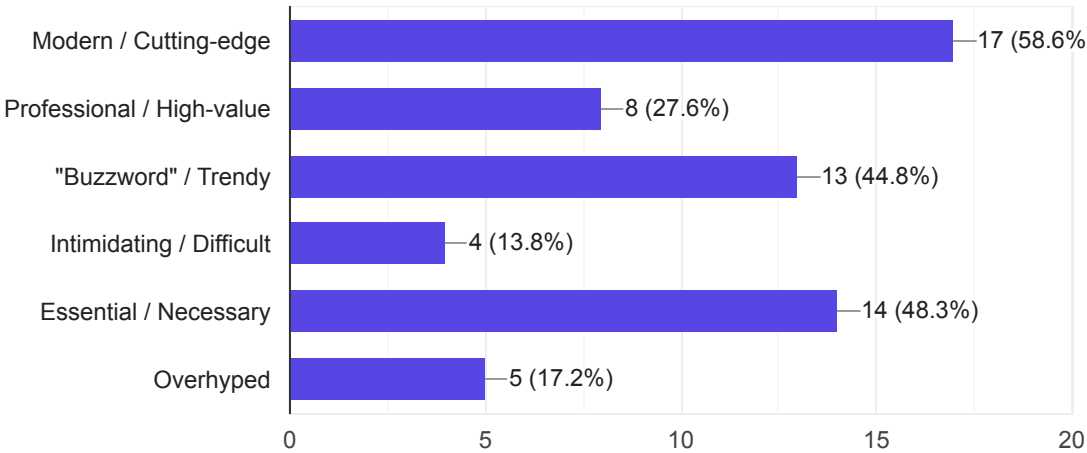
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Which of the following words best describes your reaction when you see "AI" in a college program title? (Select all that apply)

 [Copy chart](#)

29 responses



Do you have any concerns about having "AI" in the official title of your certificate? (For example: concerns about longevity, public perception, or professional reputation).

23 responses

No

No concerns. In fact, in certain circles, such a term within a certification would be quite advantageous.

I feel its important for prospective employers to know that you have an understanding of how to use AI. Its also important to know what AI can and can't do currently.

I'm concerned about AI making generated summaries about the person's profile and sharing too much personal information about them. For example, sites like YouTube have AI generated summaries in the description, even with videos uploaded several years ago, and the creator may or may not be aware of it. Also, AI is affecting the way we browse the Internet. Many of us use Google to look up anything that comes to our mind. Nowadays, it's common to see an "AI overview" as the first thing at the top of the search. This can also be a positive feature, since it speeds up the process of having to look for websites since it usually gives the sources (websites). Accessing information is becoming a lot easier and quicker than the traditional days of browsing the Internet.

Public Perception & Professional Reputation

I do think that AI can be seen as lazy or lackluster at times depending on the context, so yes, it is a concern

I believe that being associated with AI is a positive thing.

Feel there is a certain stigma of AI being considered easy to use by public and will result in a bias when degree is viewed

No, as I believe AI will be more widely used as it is integrated into more products.

The education system is not moving fast enough. Job titles and positions have already flipped while we are arguing about cheating over rote memorization.

I'm just not sure if it's a good idea to add to the program

no

One of my concerns about having AI in the official title of my certificate is the public perception, as it is something that affects the environment, due to the data centers consuming large amounts of water. Most people are against the use of AI, which is something that I agree



with because I believe that if we want to normalize the use of AI in our society, we need to have more laws that limit and control its use.

Public perception

Not necessarily- I mean, you're planning to work in the tech industry, not some hippie driven conspiracy theory anti wifi artist commune, so having the skills to use the tools that are available, efficiently is definitely worth mentioning.

When I see the "AI" on an resume, I assume the employer might be biased and think the job applicant person may be under skilled.

My main concern is mainly just fatigue hearing the word AI. Especially, because 'AI' is currently attached to everything, having it in an official title might make the certificate look a bit less of an academic achievement. In software engineering, hiring managers want to see a deep understanding of core fundamentals, they might even conclude that the program focused on using AI tools as a shortcut, rather than focusing on the architecture and logic of programming.

All jobs in my field of study will either be replaced by AI or will be unrecognizable because of AI. I may be more hireable because of a title with AI in it. Maybe give two pathways, one with AI in the title and a similar one without AI in the title and see which one is chosen over the course of the next two years?

The example mentioned here about longevity is a concern. I think AI will become essential and a necessity for web development. However, it feels like it's also currently a "buzzword" in this era. The same way the word "digitize" or "cloud" or "smart" were used for everything at one point. I think eventually AI will fall into its own category but I think it just needs to be handled carefully so it's not just simply a buzzword but a good descriptor of the degree.

I believe that AI is a necessary tool for web developers so that they can have a more efficient work output and focus on the higher level web development. However with AI and public relations, it is currently viewed as negative due to its use as a shortcut rather than a tool.

not really

While I personally wouldn't mind it, I'm not entirely sure how others would perceive it, due to its ambiguity.



Are there any specific courses, skills, or topics you would like to see included in this program?

21 responses

How to use AI

Agentic Software Development (including Web Development)

I would like to know more about Django

Issues & Benefits with AI Dependency

Not that I can think of.

-Prompt Engineering

-Ethical Hacking with AI

-Serious Red Team/Blue Team exercises/events/classes

-A class that uses RTEMS, and simulates operating an interplanetary rover all semester, where the classroom feels like stepping into mission control.

Dangers of abuse of AI and how to properly use it as a tool as an individual and as a team

How to use AI in every way you can think of to do what ever we have done in the past without it. Think in terms of gov t spending to build data centers and semi conductor manufacturers and chat bots. Anything less us thievery of our school dollars and time. Get us ready for the emerging market workforce🧐

I'm interested to see swift added to the program so anyone who is interested on making software for iOS or macOS can learn how to code in swift!

NO

None

Not that I can think of.

It seems that it's covered from what I could see in the proposal- which goes way beyond prompt engineering and actually teaches you how to build with this machine. It seems amazing!

Yes. Social Engineering and Cyber Security skills/development.

Connecting Java to a database using SQL and JPA, as well an overview of Vector storage.



testing and code reviewing AI produced code.

I think there should be more mention about the ethics of AI not just in education but also in our world. There's conversation about building AI data center's in deserts, carbon footprint, companies getting rid of entry level jobs for AI. More discussion on these ethical concerns can help students have more environmental awareness with their AI usage.

I'm not sure if a course would be necessary for this but maybe a week or two on it but how to remain competitive in a world that's moving towards AI tech. We see student graduates boo'ing mentions of AI at graduations around the country and I think there's a big reason for it: Fear and uncertainty from this still fairly new technology. I think it can be a great tool and asset for developers who know how to use it. However, it's also obvious that companies are looking for more and more qualified individuals while they're leaving easier tasks to AI (although this may change...hopefully). I think it's already being covered pretty well but it could be an entire optional course. Kind of like a "Careers in Tech" kinda class or something.

As an aerospace major, it would be fun to see how a program could run numbers to produce a graph of some sort. Whether a shape of low level simulations.

no

I'm not sure If this is a good idea or not, but for your java script class, one of the assignments should be having the students try to develop a small working code snippet of their choice using the new topics they learn. I personally feel like this will help them grasp the topic a lot better when they try creating it themselves after or before trying to implement it in the guided project. This could also encourage them to receive help if they truly don't understand certain concepts.

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